

Managed, Monitored, and Backdoored Since 2019

It wasn't malware. That's why nothing saw it.

[PLACEHOLDER: name, and how you want to be credited — Suls & Co., Reversesec, or neither]

...

https://[redacted].[redacted]/[redacted]



...

https://[redacted].[redacted]

72

- 01 known malware signatures
- 02 modified core files
- 03 rogue admin users
- 04 scheduled task injection
- 05 base64 eval blocks
- 06 uploads directory PHP
- 07 htaccess rewrites
- 08 mailer scripts
- 09 obfuscated includes
- 10 plugin integrity
- 11 theme function hooks
- 12 database option injection

13 LINKS POINTING OUT OF THEIR ACCOUNT

- 14 file permission drift
- 15 recently modified files
- 16 suspicious cron entries
- 17 open redirects
- 18 orphaned backup archives
- 19 unknown SSH keys
- 20 outbound connections

home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitea.php → /home/Site A/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/siteb.php → /home/Site B/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitec.php → /home/Site C/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sited.php → /home/Site D/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitee.php → /home/Site E/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitef.php → /home/Site F/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/siteh.php → /home/Site H/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitej.php → /home/Site J/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitek.php → /home/Site K/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitel.php → /home/Site L/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitem.php → /home/Site M/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/siten.php → /home/Site N/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitep.php → /home/Site P/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/siteq.php → /home/Site Q/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/siter.php → /home/Site R/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sites.php → /home/Site S/public_html/wp-config.php
home/████/public_html/wordpress/home/sitet.php → /home/Site T/public_html/wp-config.php

home/███/public_html/wordpress/home/acc.php → /home/██████/.accesshash

Account A

Account B

FollowSymLinks

```
graph LR; A[Account A] -- FollowSymLinks --> B[Account B];
```

The diagram illustrates a relationship between two accounts, Account A and Account B. A vertical light blue line separates the two accounts. A yellow line with an arrowhead at the end connects the bottom of Account A to the bottom of Account B, labeled 'FollowSymLinks'.

.accesshash

create accounts

delete accounts

suspend accounts

reset any password

rewrite DNS

rewrite mail routing

open a session as any account

site migrated,
restore tool left behind

2017

the hosting account
is touched

Jul 2019

management key
becomes readable

Apr 2020

my own security
review of this server

Jul 2026

2017-2019
customer credentials set,
never changed again

Aug 2019
the links and the tools
appear

Late 2024
provider installs
a malware scanner

Aug 2026
discovery

hundreds of support tickets and chats, both directions



the layer between the operating system and the sites

```
find /home/*/public_html -type l -exec sh -c '  
  for l; do  
    o=$(printf %s "$l" | cut -d/ -f3)  
    t=$(readlink -m "$l")  
    case "$t" in /home/"$o"/*) ;; *) printf "%s -> %s\n" "$l" "$t";; esac  
  done' _ {} +
```

run this on every shared host you are responsible for

SymLinksIfOwnerMatch

rotate credentials on a calendar

delete the restore script

...

https://[redacted].[redacted]/[redacted]



...

https://[redacted].[redacted]

What I can show

two independent lines of evidence

converging on one mechanism

the mechanism inferred before the farm was found

the query logs that would settle it were never created

What I cannot prove

who did it

when the write happened

that they used it at all

Severed. Rotated. Hardened. Same day.

The incident that gets your attention
is rarely the one doing the most damage.

This time it wasn't even the one behind the symptom.